

Definition and Types of Diseases

A disease is a condition that impairs normal functioning of the body or mind. Diseases may be classified as congenital (present at birth), such as cystic fibrosis or congenital heart defects, or acquired (developing after birth), such as tuberculosis or diabetes. Communicable diseases, like influenza and malaria, can spread from person to person, while non-communicable diseases, such as cancer and hypertension, are not infectious. Understanding the causes, transmission, and prevention of different disease types is fundamental to public health and clinical practice.